

LCD monitors are the *de facto* standard these days and are becoming ever cheaper. They offer serious value for money, and performance that get close to the best CRTs around, while occupying a fraction of your desk space. We've dug up some of the best ones your money can buy in this shootout.

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Forget swine flu, we have been well and truly bitten, or smitten by the slim bug in nearly every aspect of our lives. We've taken the plunge and sweated our way to a cellulite free existence. We've thrown out our old idiot boxes and invested hard earned cash on sexy new flat panel displays. We've even fallen for Apple's new slim notebooks and have put away our clunky old laptops in anticipation of acquiring one of these beauties. Sleek cellphones... slim PMPs,

what's next? Slim washing machines and refrigerators? Indeed, a few years down the line, designers may come up with something on those lines. People have also bucked the prevailing recessionary trend by splurging on the super slim LED displays that have just emerged in stores around the country. After all, it's only by spending more that the economic laws of supply and demand can do their job.

LCD monitors aren't as hot as LCD and plasma televisions since they've been in markets for much longer and most people already own one. However, prices that crashed sometime early last year have

continued to fall and today one can buy a 22-inch monitor for under Rs. 10,000. One of the reasons for these falling prices is the economics related to large-scale production that all manufacturers have cashed in on. Allied technologies have also become cheaper as a result of the burgeoning demand. Larger panels are becoming more prevalent as more and more people want a better viewing experience. Size matters, as any gamer or HTPC user will tell you. Even if all you want to do is surf, there is just no substitute for a larger display area. Gone are the days when a 19-inch display was the *de facto* standard — these days settle for

Step into the light

Imaging: Chaitanya Surpur
Photograph: Manas Parekh

